

TIMELINE 1861

Secession of the Lower South ■ **Southern seizure of Federal property** ■ Congress of the Confederacy ■ **Inauguration of Lincoln** ■ Surrender of Fort Sumter ■ **Lincoln's call for volunteers** ■ Blockade of the South ■ **Secession of Virginia** ■ Union success in Kentucky ■ **First Battle of Bull Run** ■ *Trent* Affair

“My countrymen, one and all,
think calmly and well ... In **your hands**, my **dissatisfied fellow countrymen**, and not in **mine**, is the **momentous issue of civil war.**”

ABRAHAM LINCOLN, INAUGURAL ADDRESS, MARCH 4, 1861

JANUARY	FEBRUARY	MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE	JULY	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER
JANUARY 2 South Carolina troops take Fort Johnson, Charleston Harbor. JANUARY 5 Alabama forces seize Fort Morgan and Fort Gaines at Mobile.				MAY 6 The Arkansas state legislature votes for secession. A large majority in Tennessee does likewise, though this must be confirmed by a popular vote. MAY 10 John Bull (British) and conflict between North and South.	JUNE 3 Union forces led by Major General McClellan win a victory at Phillips, Virginia. JUNE 10 Union forces suffer a minor defeat at Battle of Church, Virginia.		AUGUST 2 Congress passes a tax and tariff bill to finance the Union war effort. It includes provision for a national income tax, though this is not put into effect. AUGUST 10 Battle of Wilson's Creek. Missouri Union forces retreat after a hard fought encounter.	SEPTEMBER 3 Further Confederate forces are sent into Kentucky. The state has tried to remain neutral in the war, but this move effectively ends the attempt. SEPTEMBER 6 Confederate flag.	OCTOBER 1 President Davis discusses Southern offensive from Virginia. OCTOBER 4 The South makes treaties with some Indian tribes. Some warriors subsequently fight as Confederates.		DECEMBER 3 President Lincoln makes his State of the Union address to Congress. His central message is that "the Union must be preserved." DECEMBER 6 The Trent Affair.
JANUARY 9 Mississippi secedes from the Union. A U.S. Navy supply ship is fired on at Fort Sumter. JANUARY 10 Florida secedes. Forts Jackson and St. Philip and arsenal at Baton Rouge are taken by Louisiana state forces.		MARCH 4 Inauguration of President Davis. MARCH 6 Jefferson Davis issues a call for 100,000 volunteers to join the Confederate Army.	APRIL 10 Brigadier General P. G. T. Beauregard ordered to force Fort Sumter to surrender. It falls four days later. APRIL 15 President Lincoln calls for 75,000 volunteers to suppress the "Southern insurrection."		JUNE 17 Battle of Booneville. Union forces from St. Louis win a victory that will help them control the Missouri state capital at Jefferson City.	JULY 4 In a special session of Congress, President Lincoln speaks of the indivisibility of the Union and calls for 400,000 volunteers to defeat "domestic foes." JULY 5 Confederate troops win a minor victory at Cape Girardeau, in southeast Missouri.	AUGUST 28 Heavy raincoats Confederate forces establish a blockade line in the Tennessee Strait, North Carolina. SEPTEMBER 6 Union troops under Brigadier General Ulysses S. Grant occupy Paducah, Kentucky.	OCTOBER 9 Union forces take an unsuccessful attack on Union Forts in Santa Rosa Island, Pensacola Bay, Florida. OCTOBER 21 Union forces take the defeated at Ball's Bluff, near Lewisburg, Virginia.		DECEMBER 26 Administration agrees to release the Confederates emptying arrested on the Trent and offer a partial apology to Britain. This ends the threatened confrontation between Britain and the Union.	
	FEBRUARY 1 Iowa withdraws from the Union following an overwhelming vote by the state convention. FEBRUARY 4 Delegates of the seven seceded states meet as Provisional Congress of the Confederate States of America.			MAY 10 Union troops take arms from the Missouri state militia near St. Louis. MAY 13 Britain announces it will remain neutral. MAY 20 North Carolina votes for secession.	JUNE 24 Union troops occupy Alexandria, Virginia. MAY 30 Atlantic Squadron flagship USS Wabash leaves New York.	JULY 13 A Union victory at Carter's Creek, Virginia, concludes a series of Union successes. JULY 21 The First Battle of Fort Mifflin. Union forces are defeated and retreat in disorder.	AUGUST 30 Union commander in Mexico General Fremont of his emancipating Black people enslaved by secessionists.	SEPTEMBER 20 Lexington, Missouri, falls to Confederate forces after a brief siege. SEPTEMBER 24 Union troops under Brigadier General Fremont are arrested on board the British ship Trent, raising tensions between the Union and Britain.	NOVEMBER 7 Battle of Ball's Bluff, near Lewisburg, Virginia. NOVEMBER 8 The Trent Affair. Two Confederate diplomats are arrested on board the British ship Trent, raising tensions between the Union and Britain.		DECEMBER 26 Administration agrees to release the Confederates emptying arrested on the Trent and offer a partial apology to Britain. This ends the threatened confrontation between Britain and the Union.
	FEBRUARY 9 Abraham Lincoln is chosen as provisional president of the Confederacy. Davis first learns his news in a telegram the next day. FEBRUARY 18 President Davis is inaugurated.	MARCH 4 Abraham Lincoln is inaugurated as the 16th President of the United States. MARCH 6 Jefferson Davis issues a call for 100,000 volunteers to join the Confederate Army.	APRIL 17 Virginia's state convention secedes, with final decision to be made by its people in May. It effectively joins the Confederacy. APRIL 19 President Lincoln proclaims the South is now under blockade.	MAY 24 Union troops occupy Alexandria, Virginia. MAY 30 Atlantic Squadron flagship USS Wabash leaves New York.		JULY 26 Confederate state troops force Union soldiers to abandon Fort Filmore, New Mexico.					
	FEBRUARY 22 Speaking at Philadelphia, Lincoln declares: "There is no need of bloodshed and war."	MARCH 31 The federal outpost at Fort Mifflin, Texas, is surrendered to state troops.	APRIL 19 Pro-Rebel Marylanders clash with Union troops in Baltimore, resulting in the battles of war.	MAY 27 Lincoln suspends Habeas corpus in Maryland. Two days later the state votes against secession.							
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